CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

FLIGHT ATTENDANT IN THE AI ERA

Can a robot serve drinks at 35,000 feet? Legally, a human has to be standing in that aisle.

★ **TL;DR — Median ~$45K, training measured in weeks-to-months (1–6 months band). The catch: you don't pick the airline's base or schedule — seniority does, and you're last in line.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

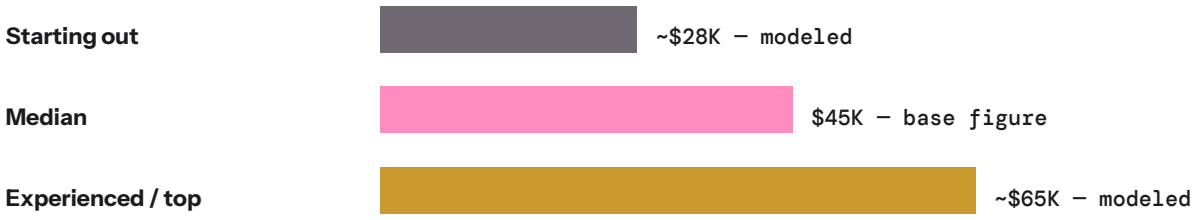
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW · CERTIFICATE

- No degree needed: airlines run their own training and certify you themselves.
- Pay and quality of life both run on seniority — the early years are the cheap years.
- AI handles bookings and check-in; the safety job inside the cabin is mandated human work.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Flight Attendant is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A FLIGHT ATTENDANT ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Run safety demos, cabin checks and emergency procedures on every flight
- ✓ Serve food and drinks while walking a moving aisle for hours

✓ Handle sick, scared and difficult passengers mid-air

✓ Do security checks, boarding and turnaround tasks between legs

Think: a safety officer who also serves coffee — in a metal tube, on someone else's schedule.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Ticketing, check-in, rebooking and routine announcements are automated or app-based. Airlines use software to plan crews and predict delays, shrinking the admin around the job.	Evacuations, medical events, unruly passengers and smoke in the cabin need a trained human physically present, and aviation rules require a minimum crew per flight. That requirement is the moat.

⚠ **The first years are reserve schedules and junior bases: you live where the airline sends you and fly when they call.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Free and discounted flights as a built-in perk ✓ No two workdays in the same city ✓ Work blocks followed by real stretches of days off	✗ Nights, weekends and holidays are peak flying time ✗ Reserve life means your phone owns your plans ✗ Time zones wreck sleep and routine

Good fit? Calm under pressure, genuinely people-proof, and fine with a schedule that changes monthly.

Bad fit? You need a fixed routine, your own bed every night, or a fast climb to high pay.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — GET HIRED BY AN AIRLINE	DOOR B — CHARTER AND PRIVATE AVIATION
The standard route: apply during airline hiring windows, pass interviews and background checks, then complete the airline's own training school. Graduation earns the FAA certificate tied to that aircraft type — the airline trains you, and you commit to their base system.	Corporate and charter operators hire cabin attendants separately, sometimes valuing hospitality or culinary background over airline history. Schedules and pay vary widely, and training standards depend on the operator — vet them carefully.

Smart move: Apply to every airline hiring at once and say yes to any base: seniority starts the day you're hired, and you can bid to move later.
Where you land after: Senior cabin crew on better routes → purser / lead attendant → instructor or base operations roles.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
CHECK THE	APPLY TO	PASS INTERVIEWS	COMPLETE AIRLINE	SURVIVE RESERVE	BID UP

STEP 1 — Check the fit and requirements

FREE · TODAY

- Airlines require a high-school diploma, customer-service experience, and passing background and medical checks.
- Reach, height and passport rules exist because of the equipment and routes — read them before applying.

STEP 2 — Apply to every open airline

FREE · WEEKS

- Hiring opens in short windows; apply broadly instead of waiting for one dream carrier.
- Customer-service stories — de-escalation, emergencies, difficult people — are what interviews score.

STEP 3 — Pass interviews and checks

FREE · WEEKS

- Group exercises and role-plays test how you handle strangers under stress.
- Background checks, drug screening and medical clearance are standard for safety-sensitive roles.

STEP 4 — Complete airline training

PROVIDED · WEEKS

- Emergency procedures, first aid, firefighting, evacuation and security — pass/fail, with exams.
- Graduating earns the FAA certificate of demonstrated proficiency for your aircraft type.

STEP 5 — Survive reserve

FIRST MONTHS

- New hires sit reserve: on call for trips, based where assigned.
- Learn the bidding system — schedules improve strictly with seniority.

STEP 6 — Bid up and specialize MONTH 6+

- Bid for better routes, international flying or lead roles as seniority grows.
- Language skills and premium-cabin qualifications improve your bids.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- ☐ Today: list every airline currently hiring and check you meet their base requirements.
- ☐ Days 1–30: apply to all open windows; prep interview stories from any service job you've held.
- ☐ Days 31–60: interviews and assessments; keep applications open with other carriers in parallel.
- ☐ Days 61–90: complete background and medical checks; training class scheduled or started.
- ☐ Day 90: you're in the pipeline — the certificate and your first reserve schedule are the next milestones.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **THE AISLE STAYS HUMAN.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.